The Lovable Deck Protocol: Building React-Powered Presentations

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Build slide decks that actually impress clients using React-powered presentations

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Part 1: The Paradigm Shift (App vs. Deck)

Why your next presentation should be a React Application

The "Good Enough" Trap

Gamma, Google Slides, and PowerPoint still have a place—finance and consulting firms live in `.pptx`. But for founders, creative directors, and product leaders, **"good enough" is dead**. The bar for attention has been raised.

This guide is not about making "faster" slides. It's about making **better software** that happens to look like slides.

What Is Lovable? (The Tech Stack)

Lovable is not a presentation tool—it's an **AI-powered full-stack app builder**.

Component	Technology
Framework	React 18 + TypeScript
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Components	shadcn/ui
Build Tool	Vite

Why this matters: Your "slides" are actually a web application. You get 60fps animations, interactive hover states, responsive layouts, and polish that usually requires a frontend engineering team.

The Mental Shift: Slides vs. States

> ⚠️ **The biggest mistake:** Thinking in "PowerPoint terms" and prompting "Make me a presentation with 10 slides."

A slide deck in Lovable is a **Single Page Application (SPA)**.

Old Thinking	New Thinking
"Go to next slide"	"Update the State from view: 1 to view: 2"

Each "slide" is just a full-screen React component. "Navigation" is just a function that swaps which component is visible.

The Economy: Credits System

Tier	Credits	Best For
Free	5/day	Testing
Pro	~100/mo ($21)	Serious work

Key updates:

- **Agent Mode** (default): AI thinks, plans, acts autonomously—costs more but fewer mistakes
- **Usage-Based**: Simple edits <1 credit, complex changes >1 credit
- **Visual Edits**: Tweak text, colors, padding manually = **0 credits**

👉 Get started at lovable.dev

Part 2: The Foundation (Context & Setup)

How to prompt the "Brain" before you build the body

The "Empty Prompt" Mistake

> ❌ **Don't:** Type "Make a pitch deck for my startup" immediately

Lovable guesses your brand colors, tone, and layout. You burn 10 credits fixing what it guessed wrong.

> ✅ **Do:** Establish Project Context first

Step 1: Create the Knowledge File

Use Chat Mode to generate your project brain. Toggle "Chat Mode" and paste:

```
I want to create a Knowledge File for a new presentation project.
```

```
Ask me 5 questions about the Audience, the Visual Brand (colors/fonts), the T
one, and the Technical Constraints.

Once I answer, generate a markdown file called project_context.md that I can
save.
```

Save the output as a file and upload it to Lovable. Now it knows your hex codes and constraints forever.

Step 2: The Prompting Golden Rule

> 📖 From Lovable's official docs: **Break work into small, testable blocks.**

❌ Bad Prompt	✅ Good Prompt
"Make a 10-slide deck about Q4 financials with animations and a contact form"	"Build the navigation skeleton for 10 slides. Don't add content yet. Just make the arrow keys work."

Step 3: The Foundation Prompt ⭐

This is the most important prompt. It sets up the physics of your world.

```
Create a presentation slide deck app with these specifications:

STRUCTURE:
• Full-screen slides (100vh x 100vw)
• Keyboard navigation: Arrow keys, Space, Enter to advance; Escape for over
view
• On-screen navigation: Subtle prev/next buttons at screen edges
• Progress indicator: Dots at bottom showing current position
• Total slides: 5 (Just use placeholders for now, e.g., 'Slide 1', 'Slide 2')

DESIGN SYSTEM:
• Theme: [Insert 'Dark' or 'Light']
• Background: [Insert Hex Code, e.g., #0f172a]
• Typography: Clean sans-serif, large headings (48px+), readable body (24px
```

```
+)
• Spacing: Generous whitespace, content centered, 64px padding

ANIMATIONS:
• Use Framer Motion for all transitions
• Slides: Fade + horizontal slide (0.4s ease-out)
• AnimatePresence mode='wait' to prevent overlap

CONSTRAINT:
Build the navigation system first. Confirm keyboard shortcuts work before add
ing any detailed content.
```

> ⚠️ **Critical:** If arrow keys don't work on placeholder slides, **do not proceed**. Fix the engine before you paint the car.

Part 3: The Assembly Line (Templates & Patterns)

Copy-paste prompts for the 5 essential slide types

The "Frankenstein" Risk

If you just say "Add a title slide," Lovable might rewrite your entire codebase, delete navigation, or change fonts.

Pattern 1: The Guardrail Protocol ⭐

Append this footer to EVERY prompt:

```
Do NOT modify:
• The navigation system or state logic.
• Any other existing slides.
• The global color scheme.
• The animation timing.
```

```
Only write code for the requested component/slide.
```

Pattern 2: Reference Known Styles

Use design shorthand:

- "Design this like an **Apple Keynote** (Lots of negative space, huge typography)"
- "Design this like a **Stripe landing page** (Clean gradients, subtle shadows, floating cards)"

📋 The Template Library

1️⃣ Title Slide (The Hook)

Goal: Cinematic entrance

```
Design Slide 1 as the Title Slide:

• Layout: Centered content, vertical stack.
• Elements:
  ○ Company Logo (Placeholder 200px width).
  ○ Main Title: '[YOUR TITLE]' (72px, Bold, Tight tracking).
  ○ Subtitle: '[YOUR SUBTITLE]' (24px, 60% opacity).
• Animation Sequence (Framer Motion):
  ○ Logo fades in (0s delay).
  ○ Title slides up + fades in (0.3s delay).
  ○ Subtitle fades in (0.5s delay).
• Background: Subtle animated gradient (Deep Navy to Black).
```

2️⃣ Metrics Slide (The Proof)

Goal: Impress investors with data

Design Slide 2 as a Metrics Grid:

- Layout: 2×2 Grid of cards.
- Content:
  - Card 1: '[VALUE]' / [LABEL]
  - Card 2: '[VALUE]' / [LABEL]
  - (etc...)
- Interactivity: Cards lift -4px and show a subtle border glow on hover.
- Animation: Numbers should 'count up' from 0 to the final value over 1.5 seco nds when the slide appears.

3️⃣ Comparison Slide (The Sales Pitch)

Goal: Show why you win

Design Slide 3 as a Feature Comparison:

- Layout: Three columns (Competitor A, Competitor B, Us).
- Styling:
  - Columns have glassmorphism backgrounds.
  - The 'Us' column is slightly larger, has a border highlight, and a 'Recomme nded' badge.
- Content: List 5 features. Use Green Checkmarks for us, Gray Xs for them.
- Animation: Stagger the entrance of the columns from left to right.

4️⃣ Team Slide (The Trust)

Goal: Humanize the deck

Design Slide 4 for the Team:

- Layout: Horizontal row of 4 profiles.
- Components:
  - Circular avatars (150px).
  - Name (Bold) and Title (Muted) below.

• Interaction: When hovering over a face, scale it up 1.05x and show their LinkedIn icon.
• Style: Minimalist. No heavy borders.

5️⃣ Product Slide (The Demo)

Goal: Show, don't tell

Design Slide 5 as a Product Showcase:

• Layout: Split screen (Text on left, Visual on right).
• Visual: A Mac-style window container (traffic light buttons at top) with a slight drop shadow.
• Inside the window: Place a placeholder image or a syntax-highlighted code block.
• Animation: The window should 'tilt' slightly in 3D space based on mouse position (Parallax effect).

⚠️ Iterate, Don't Binge

1. Add Title Slide → Check it
2. Add Metrics Slide → Check it
3. If navigation breaks → Fix immediately before moving on

Part 4: The "Credit-Saver" & The Polish

How to make it look expensive without burning your budget

The "Pixel-Peeping" Trap

> ❌ **Don't:** Prompt "Move the title down 10 pixels" — burns credits on a $0 task

The AI might hallucinate and break the layout while trying to move one text box.

1. Visual Edits: Your Wallet-Saver

Cost: 0 Credits ✨

When to use:

- Fixing typos
- Changing colors
- Adjusting font sizes
- Fine-tuning margins/padding

How to use:

1. Hover over preview window
2. Click **Select Element** icon (cursor)
3. Click the element to change
4. Edit properties in side panel
5. Save

> 💡 **Pro Tip:** Let AI build the house; you paint the walls yourself.

2. Animations That Don't Suck

Default Lovable animations can be cheesy. For "Apple Keynote" feel, use this:

The "Apple Style" Animation Prompt

```
Refine the animations for this slide using Framer Motion:

• Orchestration: Use staggerChildren so the title appears first, then the subtitl
e, then the cards (0.1s delay between each).
• Easing: Use ease-out (cubic-bezier) instead of spring physics. It should feel
smooth, not bouncy.
• Duration: Cap all transitions at 0.4s.
• Entry: Elements should fade in (opacity 0→1) and slide up slightly (y: 20→0).
• Performance: Add will-change: transform to the animated elements.
```

3. Mobile Responsiveness

> 📱 **Reality:** 50% of viewers will open your deck on their phone.

The Mobile Retrofit Prompt

Run this after desktop version is complete:

```
Make the presentation fully responsive for mobile (screens under 768px):

1. Typography: Use clamp() for font sizes so big titles shrink automatically.
2. Layout: Stack all grid columns vertically (e.g., The 'Comparison' slide colum
ns should sit on top of each other).
3. Navigation:
  ○ Hide the 'Arrow Key' hints.
  ○ Make the 'Next/Prev' touch targets at least 44px (thumb-friendly).
  ○ Enable Swipe Gestures (Swipe Left/Right to change slides).
4. Density: Hide non-essential decorative elements on mobile to save screen s
pace.
```

Part 5: Debugging, Deploying & Reality

What to do when the AI breaks your code

The "Entropy" of AI Coding

> As your deck gets larger, the AI gets confused. You'll ask for a simple change on Slide 5, and navigation on Slide 1 stops working.

Don't panic. This is normal.

1. The "I Am Frustrated" Protocol

Official Lovable best practice for breaking AI loops

Switch to **Chat Mode** (don't edit code) and type:

```
I am frustrated. Every time you update the styling on Slide 3, the global naviga
tion breaks.

Stop editing.
Analyze the codebase.
Explain to me why this is happening and propose a fix that isolates the slide c
ontent from the navigation logic.
```

Once it explains the fix, switch to Builder Mode and say: **"Implement the fix you just described."**

2. Version Control: Your Time Machine

When to Pin:

- "Navigation Works"
- "Slide 1 Complete"
- "Mobile View Fixed"

How to Pin:

1. Click History icon (clock)
2. Find working version
3. Click Pin

Rollback Prompt:

```
Revert the code to the state it was in at [Time/Version Name].
```

3. Publishing & Presenter Mode

One-Click Deploy

1. Click **Share → Publish**
2. Get URL: `project-name.lovable.app`

3. Optional: Connect custom domain in Settings

Presenter Superpowers Prompt

Add pro presentation controls:

> Add hidden keyboard listeners for presenter controls:
>
> - Press 'F': Toggle Fullscreen.
> - Press 'B': Turn screen Black (for pauses).
> - Press 'O': Show a grid overview of all slides.
> - Press 'T': Show a small, semi-transparent timer in the bottom right corner.

4. The "No-Go" Zone ⚠️

Limitation	Workaround
No Offline Mode	Keep PDF export as backup
20-Slide Wall	Break into separate projects
No Export to PPT	It's code, not .pptx

✅ Summary Checklist

- [ ] Set up **Project Context** (Knowledge File)
- [ ] Build **Foundation** with navigation skeleton
- [ ] Add slides using **Templates** with guardrails
- [ ] **Polish** with Visual Edits (0 credits)
- [ ] Add **Apple-style animations**
- [ ] Make **mobile responsive**
- [ ] **Pin** working versions regularly
- [ ] **Publish** and add presenter controls

> 💡 **Stop building static slides. Start building experiences.**